INTERNAL · OUTREACH PLAYBOOK

Outreach Pack

Copy-paste-ready VC emails · Family Office emails · Phone scripts · Q&A drill · Operational notes.

ROUND USD $5M priced equity · AU-domiciled
DATE May 2026

HONG KONG · SYDNEY · SAN FRANCISCO · LONDON · CHANNEL ISLANDS

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Subject: Intro – FutureProof (Pre-Series A SAFE, fintech-specialist fit)

> *Hi [VC Partner first name],*
> *[Connector first name] suggested I reach out.*
> *I'm raising the **Pre-Series A SAFE** for **FutureProof** – the AI-native SaaS platform turning home equity into guaranteed retirement income, licensing banks and insurers as Product Issuers. $25T regulated tailwind across US/UK/Australia (US 36M retirees + Australia's Retirement Income Covenant + UK equity-release maturity). **Post-money SAFE, uncapped, 30% discount** to Series A 2028 (discount reduces progressively as the round fills). USD $1M minimum.*
> *Live ecosystem:*
>
> - ***Accenture** as Global Collaboration Partner & Approved Business Intermediary*
> - ***Jones Day** as Global Legal Partner*
> - *Product co-design with **BlackRock, SpiderRock, Atlas SP / Apollo***
> - *In active negotiation: Lockton Re, Gallagher Re, PIMCO, Munich Re, Macquarie*
> - *AU market launch Q4/2026; UK Q2/2027; USA Q4/2027*
>
> *Honest disclosure up front: this is specialty-insurance / AUM-platform economics with SaaS-margin profile (~89% blended Y5 EBITDA), not pure SaaS. 7–10 year exit window. **Happy to qualify out in 10 minutes if it's not a fit for the fund** – that's the deal.*
> *30 minutes next 2 weeks?*
> *Mike Spidaliere · FTFC mike@ftfc.co · [Mobile] [Calendly link]*

Operational notes:

- This block reads as if Mike wrote it (first-person). The connector will add their own one-line intro above and forward.
- Replace `Mike Spidaliere · FTFC · mike@ftfc.co` with `Max Goldberg · Gold Capital Consulting · max@goldcapitalconsulting.com` if Max is the sender.
- The "happy to qualify out in 10 minutes" line is a deliberate VC-pattern signal – partners respect founders who don't waste time.

A2. Direct from Mike or Max (existing relationship with the partner)

> ***When to use:** Mike or Max has worked with this partner before, fund member, or close peer. No connector needed.*
> ***Word count:** 130*

Subject: Quick one – fintech-platform Pre-Series A SAFE

> *Hi [Partner first name],*
> *Hope you're well – been a while.*
> *I'm running the US capital raise for* ***FutureProof*** *(Pre-Series A SAFE – post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028, USD $1M min, rolling close). It's a regulated retirement-income platform – converts home equity into guaranteed income via Product Issuer licensing to banks/insurers. AU launch Q4/2026.*
> *Why I think it could be your shape:*
>
> - *Regulated B2B SaaS-economics on $25T addressable tailwind*
> - *Pre-launch ecosystem already has Accenture, Jones Day, BlackRock, Apollo*
> - *Founder is John Innes – co-founded/exited a digital insurer; ex-Allianz*
> - *Senior actuarial team led by Pavel Shevchenko (Macquarie Prof, ex-CSIRO) and John De Ravin (ex-Director Swiss Re)*
>
> *Worth 20 mins?*
> *Mike*

Operational notes:

- Open with a *low-effort* social opener – peers don't need formality
- The "Why I think it could be your shape" framing puts the work on Mike, not the recipient
- Three named credibility points (Accenture/Apollo + Innes + actuarial team) sized for an 8-second skim
- 20-min ask (not 30) is lower-commitment for an existing relationship

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A3. Cold outreach with a specific connection hook

> ***When to use:*** *No warm intro, but you have one specific reason to write to this partner – a portfolio investment, public statement, panel, or article. Use sparingly. Tier-A specialists only.*
> ***Word count:*** *165*

Subject: Following up on your [Athena / Bestow / Hippo] thesis – $25T retirement-income platform

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> *Hi [Partner first name],*
> *Saw your investment in [Athena / portfolio company] – the regulated-fintech-platform-with-real-rails thesis is exactly the shape we're building.*
> *I'm running the US capital raise for* ***FutureProof*** *– AI-native SaaS platform converting retiree home equity into guaranteed income, licensing banks/insurers as Product Issuers. Pre-Series A SAFE – post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028. USD $1M min, rolling close.*
> *Three reasons it's worth 15 minutes:*
>
> 1. ***$25T regulated tailwind*** *– US 36M retirees + Australia's Retirement Income Covenant requires every super fund to have a retirement-income strategy*
> 2. ***Pre-launch institutional ecosystem already in place*** *– Accenture (global collab partner), Jones Day (legal), BlackRock + SpiderRock + Atlas SP/Apollo (product co-design), Lockton Re + PIMCO (in negotiation)*
> 3. ***Specialty-insurance economics with SaaS-margin profile*** *– ~89% blended Y5 EBITDA on a fee model (we don't warehouse risk)*
>
> *Honest disclosure: 7–10 yr exit window. If your fund needs every position to plausibly return the fund on its own, please tell me on the call and we'll close the loop.*
> *15 min next week?*
> *Mike Spidaliere · FTFC mike@ftfc.co · [Mobile]*

Operational notes:

- The portfolio-company reference in the opening proves you're not spamming
- 15 minutes (not 30) lowers the commitment threshold for a cold ask
- The three-bullet structure maps to: (a) market, (b) traction, (c) economics – what a partner needs to evaluate fit
- Honest-disclosure framing is the differentiator – most cold emails over-claim; this one qualifies out

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A4. Follow-up after first meeting

> ***When to use:*** *Same-day or next-day after a 30-minute first call. Always send within 18 hours.*
> ***Word count:*** *130*

Subject: Thanks – FutureProof materials + [specific topic from the call]

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> *Hi [Partner first name],*
> *Thanks for the time today. Three follow-ups from what we discussed:*
>
> 1. ***[Specific topic they raised]*** *— attaching the [relevant artefact: AI architecture one-pager / financial-model 3-case summary / honest-disclosure block].*
> 2. ***Investor deck*** *— full 19-slide pack attached. The VC-extension section (slides E1–E4) covers the honest-disclosure block, exit comps, expansion roadmap, and architecture-and-moat questions.*
> 3. ***Data room access*** *— happy to share under NDA whenever you're ready. Includes the proprietary financial model (50,000-path Monte Carlo validation), regulatory engagement memos, and partner LOIs.*
>
> *Next step on your side? I'm in [city] [date]; happy to host a deeper session with John Innes (founder) and Pavel Shevchenko (Senior Actuary, who built the model).*
> *Mike*

Operational notes:

- Item 1 is the highest-impact: address the SPECIFIC concern they raised. Tailor every follow-up.
- Don't send the deck cold-out-of-the-blue — wait for genuine interest signal
- The "next step on your side" framing puts the ball in their court without being pushy
- Offering to host a deeper session with John + Pavel is the senior-team flex; only deploy after genuine interest

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A5. Quarterly update (post-pass / post-no-yet)

> ***When to use:*** *~30% of VCs that pass come back next round. Keep them on a quarterly update list. Send four times a year.*
> ***Word count:*** *180*

Subject: FutureProof Q[N] update — [headline of the quarter]

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> *Hi [Partner first name],*
> *Quarterly update – three things:*
> ***Traction:** [Concrete update, e.g. "First super-fund Product Issuer LOI signed: AMP Bank, USD $50M facility commitment for AU launch."]*
> ***Product:** [Concrete update, e.g. "Annuity & Mortgage Calculator now in beta with 250 users across 4 regions; conversion at 22% vs benchmark 8%."]*
> ***Round:** [Status, e.g. "USD $3.2M of SAFE commitments in. Discount has stepped down once; current SAFEs still capturing the higher tier. Rolling close continues."]*
> *Why I'm staying in touch: when we covered ground in [Month Year], you mentioned [specific concern]. We've now [addressed it, e.g. "secured the wholesale-funder commitment that was missing then"].*
> *If your fund's mandate or thesis has evolved, this might land differently now. Open to a 15-min catch-up.*
> *Mike Spidaliere*

Operational notes:

- The "why I'm staying in touch" line referencing their specific past concern shows attention and respect
- Three concrete bullets (traction / product / round) is the bare minimum that shows momentum
- "If your fund's mandate has evolved" is the soft-permission language that re-opens the door
- Don't ask for action – just inform. Action follows naturally if they're interested.

Section B – Family Office Outreach Emails

B1. Warm-intro forward (connector relays your text verbatim)

> ***When to use:** A connector (peer principal, wealth-platform RM, family-office adviser) has agreed to forward your email. This is the **default approach for Tier-1 single family offices** – never cold.*
> ***Word count:** 195*

Subject: [Connector first name] suggested an intro – FutureProof

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> *Hi [Principal first name],*
> *[Connector first name] suggested I reach out.*
> *I'm raising for **FutureProof** – we turn locked-up retiree home equity into guaranteed retirement income without forcing the homeowner to sell, move, or take on a debt-repayment burden. The product slots directly into what super funds now legally need to provide their members under the Retirement Income Covenant.*
> *The framing that resonates with most principals I speak with: **2.7M Australians over 65 (and 36M Americans) are sitting on a home worth $1M+ while drawing $30K a year from super**. Most refuse to downsize for entirely good reasons – community, health, identity, legacy. The traditional answer (reverse mortgage) eats the estate. We've built something structurally different.*
> ***What's already in place:***
>
> - *Accenture as Global Collaboration Partner; Jones Day as Global Legal Partner*
> - *Product co-design with BlackRock, SpiderRock, Apollo*
> - *Australian launch Q4/2026, with first super-fund Product Issuer in active negotiation*
> - *Senior actuarial team includes Dr Pavel Shevchenko (Professor, Macquarie U) and John De Ravin (ex-Director Swiss Re)*
>
> *Round is the **Pre-Series A SAFE** (post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028, USD $1M minimum), AU-domiciled corporate, USD-denominated. ESVCLP allocation available for qualifying AU investors via parallel AUD sub-tranche on the same SAFE terms.*
> *Worth 30 minutes?*
> *John R Innes Co-Founder & Executive Director john.innes@futureprooffinancial.co · +61 (0)408 306 235*

Operational notes:

- The opening human story (sitting on $1M home, drawing $30K from super, refusing to downsize) is the FO emotional hook – principals (50-75) recognise this from their own families
- "For entirely good reasons" – respects the principal's belief that their parents/peers are intelligent agents, not problems to solve
- Four named partners (Accenture / Jones Day / BlackRock / Apollo) gives credibility without name-dropping
- Mentioning Macquarie U + Swiss Re actuarial credentials reassures regulator-grade rigour
- ESVCLP framing positioned as "available for qualifying AU investors" – not the lede, but useful tax mechanic

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B2. Asking a connector for an intro

> ***When to use:*** *When you want a connector to actively make an intro (not just forward), often via their own LinkedIn / email / phone. Connector pastes your draft.*
> ***Word count:*** *150*

Subject: Quick favour – intro to [Principal name] at [Family Office]?

> *Hi [Connector first name],*
> *Hope you're well.*
> *Quick one – I'm raising the* ***Pre-Series A SAFE*** *for* ***FutureProof*** *(AI-native retirement-income platform: home equity → guaranteed income; Accenture and Jones Day already on as global partners). Post-money SAFE, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028, USD $1M min. AU launch Q4/2026.*
> *[Principal] at [Family Office] keeps coming up as a strong fit – they back [reason: e.g. "structured retirement-income theses / regulated financial platforms / patient infrastructure plays"]. Would you be comfortable making a quick intro?*
> *If it helps, here's what you could say (feel free to edit):*
>
> > *[Principal first name] – meet John Innes from FutureProof. He's the co-founder of an AI-native platform that turns retiree home equity into guaranteed retirement income; Accenture, Jones Day, and BlackRock are already on as institutional partners and they're launching in Australia Q4/2026. He's running a Pre-Series A SAFE round (uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028) and I think the structural-product novelty + regulatory tailwind would be your shape. John, [Principal] is great at [what they do]. I'll let you take it from here.*
>
> *Totally fine if it's not the right ask – happy to find another path.*
> *John*

Operational notes:

- "Quick favour" sets a small ask
- Provides ready-to-paste copy so the connector doesn't have to think
- The "totally fine if not" preserves the relationship if they decline
- Lead with the FO-relevant framing (structural-product novelty + regulatory tailwind), not VC framing

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B3. Direct from John (existing peer relationship)

> ***When to use:*** *John has met the principal at an industry event, mutual board, or prior business relationship. Used selectively – most FOs require warm intro.*
> ***Word count:*** *145*

Subject: Following up on our [event / conversation] – FutureProof

> *Hi [Principal first name],*
> *Hope you and the family are well. Following up on our conversation at [event / context].*
> *When we last spoke, you mentioned [specific topic – e.g. "the gap in retirement-income products for the AU market" / "your interest in regulated infrastructure plays"]. That's where FutureProof sits.*
> *Quick context: we're an AI-native retirement-income platform – we turn home equity into guaranteed lifetime income via Product Issuer licensing to banks and insurers. The Retirement Income Covenant has created the regulated tailwind; Accenture is our Global Collaboration Partner, Jones Day on legal, BlackRock and Apollo in product co-design. Australian launch Q4/2026.*
> *Raising via a **Pre-Series A SAFE** (post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028; USD $1M minimum). We're being selective – looking for principals who'd value the structural product novelty and the long-duration patient capital fit.*
> *Could we find 30 minutes in [next 2 weeks]?*
> *John R Innes [Mobile]*

Operational notes:

- The "your family well" opener is appropriate for FO peer-level relationships in AU
- Reference the specific past conversation – this is what makes it warm not cold
- "Being selective with the round" is honest discretion language that FO principals respect
- Don't push hard; offer the 30-min and let them respond

B4. Follow-up after first meeting

> ***When to use:*** *Same-day or next-day after a meeting.* ***Within 24 hours always.***
> ***Word count:*** *165*

Subject: Thanks – FutureProof + [specific topic from the call]

> *Hi [Principal first name],*
> *Thank you for the time today – and for [specific gracious touch from the meeting, e.g. "the perspective on what worked and didn't with X / the introduction to Y / sharing your thinking on retirement-income products generally"].*
> *Three follow-ups from our conversation:*
>
> 1. ***[Specific topic they raised]** – attaching [relevant artefact, e.g. "the briefing deck and the financial-model 3-case summary"]. The point you made about [their concern] is addressed in [section reference].*
> 2. ***References** – happy to share callable references with [Pavel Shevchenko (proprietary financial model), or relevant senior actuarial / regulatory contact, or one of our institutional partners] depending on what would be most useful.*
> 3. ***Data room** – accessible under a short NDA when you're ready. Contains the regulatory engagement memos, the 50,000-path Monte Carlo validation, and the partner LOIs.*
>
> *If it would be valuable, I'd like to host a deeper session with you and Pavel on the model, or with the broader leadership team – your preference.*
> *John*

Operational notes:

- Reference the specific gracious moment from the meeting – shows you were listening
- Address their specific concern in item 1 (don't generic-package)
- Offering references is high-trust; only deploy where appropriate
- The "deeper session with Pavel" is the senior-team flex; deploys when there's actuarial / model-depth interest

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B5. Quarterly update (post-pass / post-no-yet)

> ***When to use:** ~30% of FO principals come back next round once they've watched you execute for 6–12 months. Quarterly cadence keeps you visible.*
> ***Word count:** 165*

Subject: FutureProof Q[N] – quick update

> *Hi [Principal first name],*
> *Hope you're well – quick quarterly update on FutureProof.*
> *The three things that have moved since we spoke:*
> ***Traction:** [Specific update – e.g. "First super-fund Product Issuer LOI signed (AMP Bank, AUD $50M facility commitment for AU launch). USA partnership pipeline now 4 active conversations."]*
> ***Product:** [e.g. "Annuity & Mortgage Calculator in beta – 250 users across 4 regions, conversion at 22% vs reverse-mortgage industry benchmark of ~8%."]*
> ***Round:** [Specific update, with discretion about named investors. E.g. "USD $3.2M of SAFE commitments in. Rolling close ongoing; discount tier has stepped down once."]*
> *When we spoke in [month/year], you raised [their specific concern]. I wanted to flag we've now [addressed it].*
> *No ask – just keeping you in the loop. If anything in your own thinking has evolved, happy to find time.*
> *John*

Operational notes:

- Same structure as VC quarterly update but warmer / less metrics-heavy
- "No ask – just keeping you in the loop" is the FO-respectful framing
- Discretion about named investors – never name an FO co-investor without explicit permission

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Section C – Phone Scripts

C1. Live opening – when they pick up (30 seconds)

Scenario A: They've expressed prior interest (they're expecting roughly this call)

> *"Hi [first name], it's [Mike / Max / John]. Thanks for taking my call – is this a good moment for 5 minutes, or should I find a better time?"*
> *[Wait for confirmation.]*
> *"Great. The one-line on FutureProof: AI-native SaaS platform converting retiree home equity into guaranteed retirement income, licensing banks and insurers as Product Issuers. $25T addressable tailwind across US/UK/Australia. Live ecosystem with Accenture, Jones Day, BlackRock; Australian launch Q4/2026.*
> *"We're raising via a Pre-Series A SAFE – post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028, USD $1M minimum, rolling close. The reason I'm calling: [specific reason – e.g. "you mentioned in [prior context] that retirement income / structured-finance / regulated platforms is a current focus"].*
> *"Three things I'd love to find out from you: [their top concerns / what diligence would look like / what timing makes sense]."*

Scenario B: Cold call (they don't know who you are)

> *"Hi [first name], it's [Mike / Max / John] – I've been raising for* ***FutureProof****, and [Connector name] mentioned you might be the right person to give me 2 minutes of your view on retirement-income platforms. Is this a good moment?"*
> *[If yes, continue. If no: "No problem – when's better?" and book.]*
> *"Quick context: we're an AI-native platform turning retiree home equity into guaranteed income. Accenture, Jones Day, BlackRock are already on as institutional partners. AU launch Q4/2026. Pre-Series A SAFE – post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028, USD $1M min, rolling close.*
> *"I'm not asking you to invest on this call – I'd rather get your reaction to whether it's the kind of structural product that fits the [their fund / family-office / strategy]. 15 minutes next week?"*

Operational notes:

- "Is this a good moment?" is non-negotiable – never plough into pitch without explicit consent
- The "I'm not asking you to invest on this call" line is the lowest-pressure ask possible – always works for first calls
- For warm calls (A), reference the SPECIFIC prior context. For cold calls (B), name the connector immediately.

C2. Voicemail – 20 seconds

Standard voicemail (warm path, prior context exists):

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> *"Hi [first name], it's [Mike Spidaliere from FTFC / Max Goldberg from Gold Capital / John Innes from FutureProof]. Calling about the Pre-Series A SAFE I mentioned in [prior context]. We've had [X] of commitments come in and I wanted to share where we're up to and find a 20 minute window with you.*
> *"I'm on [mobile number]. Or if email is easier, [email]. No rush. Talk soon."*

Cold-path voicemail (no prior context):

> *"Hi [first name], [Mike Spidaliere / Max Goldberg / John Innes] here. [Connector name] suggested I reach out about a Pre-Series A SAFE I'm running for FutureProof – AI-native retirement-income platform; post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028; Accenture and Jones Day on as institutional partners.*
> *"I'd love 15 minutes to share the structure with you. I'm on [mobile] or [email]. No rush. Thanks."*

Operational notes:

- 20 seconds max – you only get 30 before they delete
- Always state your name twice (start and end) – voicemails get replayed, only the last 5 seconds get attention
- Always state the round size – saves a callback
- Include the connector's name in the cold path – that's what creates the "I should call back" trigger
- Never say "urgent" – that's a tell of inexperience

C3. Q&A drill – when they ask X, say Y

> ***Use:*** *Print this and have it next to the phone for first-call situations.*

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If they ask…	Say…
"What's the round structure?"	"Pre-Series A SAFE round, AU-domiciled corporate, USD-denominated. Post-money SAFE, uncapped valuation, 30% discount to the Qualifying Round – the Series A Growth Equity Round, scheduled 2028. Minimum cheque USD $1M. Discount reduces progressively as each SAFE is issued, so earliest investors capture the full 30%. Side letter for follow-on / pro-rata, MFN terms, no lead, rolling close. Sits alongside USD $10M of existing convertible / SAFE notes from a prior tranche at $85M val cap."
"What's the valuation?"	"There isn't one – and that's deliberate. This is an uncapped post-money SAFE, so there's no valuation cap and no pre-money number to negotiate. The pricing event is the Series A 2028, where you convert at a 30% discount to whatever clears (or better, per MFN). The bet is on Series A execution, and the discount is your protection. We'd rather have that conversation honestly than negotiate a Pre-Series A number that's not the binding event."
"What stage are you?"	"Pre-Series A SAFE. Pre-revenue today; AU market launch Q4/2026 with the first Product Issuer in negotiation; multi-region calculation engine live; customer-facing AI agent in working prototype across four regions. Annuity & Mortgage Calculator in alpha for user testing."
"Tell me about traction."	"Three layers. Institutional ecosystem: Accenture as Global Collaboration Partner, Jones Day as Global Legal Partner, product co-design with BlackRock, SpiderRock, Atlas SP / Apollo, Lockton, PWC. In active negotiation with Lockton Re, Gallagher Re, PIMCO, Munich Re, Macquarie. Recognition: Silicon Valley Fintech Accelerator 2023 cohort. Product: multi-region calculation engine and AI agent live; Annuity Calculator in alpha. Pipeline: AU super-fund Product Issuer LOIs in active discussion."
"Is this a regulated business?"	"Yes – and that's a feature, not a bug. We're in active engagement with ASIC; Jones Day is our Global Legal Partner; non-US regulatory partners are EY, Colin Biggers & Paisley, and Dentons. The regulatory permissions stack is part of the moat – 18 to 36 months for a competitor to replicate."
"Why now?"	"Three things compounding. The Retirement Income Covenant in 2022 legally requires every Australian super fund to have a retirement-income strategy – four years on, most still don't. Demographic wave: 1 in 4 Australians over 65 by 2050; 36 million US retirees today. And the AI-native operating model is what lets a small disciplined team operate the platform at software-company cost while the regulated rails are real."
"Who's the competition?"	"Reverse mortgage providers – Household Capital, Heartland – address about 5% of the addressable retiree market because compound interest eats the estate; we're structured for the other 95%. Annuity providers – Challenger, TAL – annuitise super, not home equity; possible strategic partners. Banks would face APRA capital constraints under APS 112 that make these uneconomic for ADIs. We're in a different category."

If they ask…	Say…
"Is the AI defensible?"	"No – and we don't claim it is. AI is operating leverage, not the moat. The moat is regulatory permissions plus super-fund integrations plus Futureproof's proprietary financial model – years of financial and legal engineering that don't compress under AI pressure."
"What's the burn? What's the runway?"	"Designed for ~18 months of runway to Series A 2028. Y0–Y2 burn is covered, with a buffer in the Likely case. EBITDA-positive in Year 2 across all three cases – that's Year-2 recurring EBITDA, before the first-cycle profit-share realisation in Year 5. Rolling close means we draw capital as commitments come in."
"What's the exit?"	"Realistic 7–10 year window. Three credible buyer types: super fund consolidator or aggregator – most likely; life insurer or annuity provider like Challenger or TAL or MLC Life; or IPO at scale, with Heartland Group as the AU-listed precedent. We don't model around a specific exit – we model around being a durable cash-generative business and the exit options follow from that."
"Who's the lead?"	"By design, no lead – this is an uncapped SAFE on standard terms, rolling close. There's no term sheet to lead. Early-conviction investors get the full 30% discount; later cheques get less as the discount reduces progressively. Side letter for follow-on / pro-rata is available."
"What's your founder's track record?"	"John Innes is the co-founder. 30+ years in insurance and insurtech across APAC and the USA. Former Head of Product at Australia's largest insurer. Co-founded, scaled, and exited a leading digital insurer. Ex-Allianz National Commercial Manager with a $750 million annual premium portfolio. The senior actuarial bench is unusually deep – Dr Pavel Shevchenko, who built our proprietary financial model, is a Professor at Macquarie University and ex-Principal Research Scientist at CSIRO. John De Ravin is ex-Director of Swiss Re and ex-Chief Actuary at Munich Re."
"Why isn't this just a SaaS deal?"	"Honest answer – it's not. Specialty-insurance / AUM-platform economics with SaaS-margin profile (89% blended Y5 EBITDA) on a fee model. Path to a 10–50× equity outcome depends on platform AUM growth and a strategic or IPO exit, not multiple-expansion on ARR. If your fund needs every position to plausibly return the fund on its own, this isn't your deal – and we'd rather you say that on the call than burn four weeks of process."
"What's the biggest risk?"	"Three real ones. First, regulatory reclassification – addressed by ongoing ASIC engagement and conservative product design. Second, a major strategic – Challenger or a Big Four bank – launching a competing product before we secure first super-fund distribution. Speed to first super-fund partnership is the most important defensive move. Third, distribution velocity falling short and we run out of runway. The SAFE round is sized to cover Y0–Y2 burn even in the Conservative case."

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If they ask...	Say...
"Can I see the data room?"	"Yes, under a short NDA. It includes the proprietary financial model with 50,000-path Monte Carlo validation, regulatory engagement memos, partner LOIs, the SAFE template, and the current cap table. Can I have it set up for you in 24 hours?"

C4. Closing the call – every time

The four closing moves (in order):

> 1. ***Confirm next step.*** *"What I think makes sense is [specific next step, e.g. "I send you the deck plus the AI architecture one-pager today, you have a chance to review, and we book a 45-minute follow-up next week with John on the line"]. Does that work?"*
> 2. ***Confirm method.*** *"Best way to send the materials – your direct email, or your assistant's address?"*
> 3. ***Confirm the calendar.*** *"I'll send a calendar invite for [specific time / range]. Anyone on your side you'd want me to copy in?"*
> 4. ***Permission to follow up.*** *"And if I don't hear back in [X days], OK if I follow up directly?"*

Why this works:

- Each step gets a yes/no, so you leave with actual confirmed actions
- "What I think makes sense" puts you in control of the next-step framing without being aggressive
- "Permission to follow up" pre-empts the awkward "did you see my email" follow-up – they've already said yes

What never to say at the close:

- "I'll be in touch" (vague – leaves you nothing to do)
- "Hopefully we can find time" (hope is not a strategy)
- "Let me know your thoughts" (puts the work on them; passive)
- "Can I send you the term sheet?" (way too aggressive on first call)

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Section D – Operational notes

D1. Cadence rules – never break these

1. **Never pitch Tier 1 single FOs cold.** Always warm intro. A cold email to a single family office burns the contact for 12 months minimum.
2. **Tier 2 multi-FO platforms can be approached semi-cold** with a credible angle ("we'd value 15 minutes to share how the Retirement Income Covenant is reshaping the alternatives shelf"), but warm intros convert 5-10× better.
3. **Never run more than 2 anchor candidates in parallel at "term sheet ready" stage.** Family offices and senior VCs talk. They will find out, and they will both pull.
4. **Never share the financial model with a generalist VC on first call.** Wait for genuine interest signal + signed NDA. Generalists pattern-match against the wrong comps in 5 minutes.
5. **Quarterly update list:** every "pass" goes on the quarterly update list. ~30% come back for the next round. Don't drop them.

D2. Subject-line craft – what makes them open

Good patterns:

- `[Connector] suggested...` – relationship transfer
- `Following up on [specific public thing]` – proves you read
- `[Specific category fit] – Pre-Series A SAFE` – clarity
- `Q[N] update – [specific milestone]` – useful, not asking

Avoid:

- "Quick question" (everyone uses this; they ignore)
- "Series A opportunity" / "Pre-Series A opportunity" (sounds like spam – drop the round-stage tag from subject lines)
- "Disrupting the X market" (signals founder inexperience)
- ALL CAPS, exclamation marks, urgency framing

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D3. What to attach (and when)

Stage	What to attach
First touch (cold or warm)	Briefing deck PDF (the existing professional one)
After first reply showing interest	Investor deck PDF + AI architecture one-pager
After first meeting	Whatever specific artefact addressed their concern
After NDA signed	Data room access (financial model, regulatory memos, LOIs, references)

D4. Tracking – minimum discipline

For every contact, maintain in your CRM (Affinity, Streak, or a structured Google Sheet):

- Name, role, firm, email, mobile, LinkedIn
- Warm intro path (named connector + their email)
- Date intro requested → date intro made → date 1st meeting
- Status (Cold → Intro requested → Intro made → 1st mtg booked → 1st mtg done → 2nd mtg → Diligence → Term sheet → Committed → Pass)
- Notes from each touch (date-stamped, 1-2 lines)
- Next action + due date
- Pass reason (if passed) – these are gold for the next round

D5. Three things never to say in any email or call

1. "Disruptive" – every founder says it; it signals nothing
2. "Massive market" – they can read TAM; saying "massive" undermines the actual figures
3. "Limited time" / "filling fast" – pressure tactics that experienced investors recognise as inexperience

D6. The honest-disclosure principle (VC only)

Lead-with-disclosure is the differentiator in 2026. Most pitches hide weaknesses; partner meetings discover them in week 4 and the deal dies on a process-frustration vibe.

The seven items to surface up front (per deck slide E1, FAQ Q21):

1. Fund-return math – specialty-insurance economics, not SaaS
2. Time to outcome – 7–10 year exit window
3. Capital intensity – wholesale-funder dependency

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4. Regulatory surface area – ASIC + FCA-equivalent
5. Mixed comp set – UK equity-release names have bumpy histories
6. Market education burden – quarters not viral
7. AI is operating leverage, not a moat we claim

The phrase to use verbatim: *"If any of the above is a hard veto for your fund, please tell me on the first call. We'd rather close the loop fast than burn four weeks of process."*

This phrase, deployed in the first 30 seconds of any VC call, is the single highest-leverage line in the entire outreach pack. Most founders are terrified to say it. It's the line that separates founders from operators.

Section E – Cross-references

- **PLAN.md** – Phase plan + decision gates
- **target_list.md** – Tier 1/2/3/4 named targets with status columns
- **teaser.md / teaser_vc.md** – 1-pagers to attach
- **deck_outline.md** – Source for slide-by-slide content
- **faq.md** – 26 pre-empted objections; deeper than the Q&A drill in this doc
- **ai_architecture.md** – For VC technical / diligence questions
- **Financial Model** – for diligence calls; data room only

Last updated: 2026-05-04 · Round: Pre-Series A SAFE (post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028, USD $1M min) · Domicile: AU · Capital raise: Mike Spidaliere (FTFC) + Max Goldberg (Gold Capital) US · John R Innes (Co-Founder & ED) AU/global

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